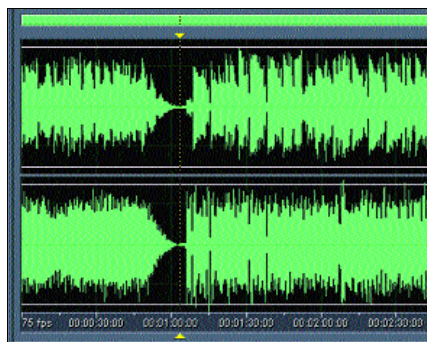


excess noise, or the background noise. To do this, select a few seconds of the recording that has just noise, and no music. Select the portion that's just about 3 seconds before the first song, go to **Effects > Noise Reduction > Noise Reduction** and click on 'Get Profile from Selection' to scan the selection, and make a noise profile. Click Close. Now, deselect the area, and return to **Effects > Noise Reduction > Noise Reduction**. Press Preview to hear the effect of the noise reduction. If the sound is changed dramatically, then reduce the level of noise reduction applied. Conversely, if the noise is still too much, increase the amount. If the noise reduction does not seem to be very effective, or makes the track sound very different, refine the selection used to make the noise profile, and repeat the process. When you are satisfied with the results, click OK. CEP will now apply the noise reduction, which may take quite a while, depending on the speed of your PC. Normally, noise is most audible in quiet areas between tracks. A good idea is to apply less noise reduction than what is actually required, so that it just gets removed from the music, and you can completely remove any audio from in between songs. Do this by selecting the area, and going to **Effects > Silence**.

You can also apply equalization to the music to make it sound smoother, or to give it more punch. Select the area you want to equalize, and go to **Effects > Filters > Graphic Equalizer**. Choose from the numerous preset settings available, or simply go ahead and make your own changes. The bars modify lower to higher frequencies from right to left. The lower frequencies



Place the marker before the start of a new song

represent bass and lower notes. The mid-range is where you find the vocals.

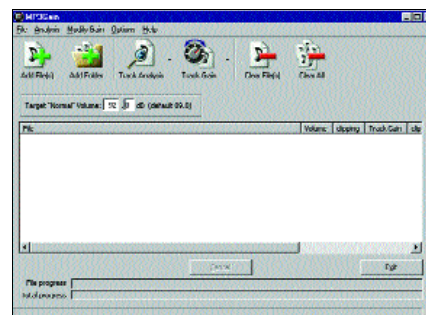
After you're satisfied with the overall sound, you can split the long wave into individual files for each song. Place the cursor exactly where you want to cut the file. You can move the cursor in small increments by pressing the left or right arrow keys. Increase the zoom to increase the accuracy. Place this marker just before the start of a new song and press [F8] to make a new cue at the cursor. Do this for all the songs, and then place one marker at the start of the first song, and another at the end of the last song.

Go to **View > Show Cue List**. Select the first item, and press [Shift] + [End] to select all the cue items. Now, press Merge to convert the individual Cues to Cue

Label	Begin	End	Length	Type	Description
Cue 1	00:00:24:10	00:03:10:00	00:03:45:05	Basic	
Cue 2	00:03:10:00	00:05:28:22	00:02:48:14	Basic	
Cue 3	00:05:28:22	00:07:55:23	00:02:27:01	Basic	
Cue 4	00:07:55:23	00:11:02:21	00:03:10:09	Basic	
Cue 5	00:11:02:21	00:13:43:47	00:02:37:16	Basic	
Cue 6	00:13:43:47	00:15:46:10	00:02:02:23	Basic	
Cue 7	00:15:46:10	00:18:11:51	00:02:25:41	Basic	
Cue 8	00:18:11:51	00:24:00:28	00:05:48:37	Basic	
Cue 9	00:24:00:28	00:25:35:31	00:01:35:03	Basic	
Cue 10	00:25:35:31	00:26:32:32	00:01:00:01	Basic	
Cue 11	00:26:32:32	00:29:02:73	00:02:30:41	Basic	

Merging in the Cue List

Ranges. Notice the Begin and End times for each individual track. Click on Batch, and select the 'Save to Files' radio button from the window that comes up. Enter a filename prefix, and browse to the folder where you wish to save the files. Set the output format as MP3, and click Options to set the quality manually. Once you're done, click OK, and then OK again to begin outputting your files. You will now find a separate MP3 file for each track,



Use MP3 Gain to make all your songs the same volume

which you can use to make a CD.

Normally, songs from different artists tend to be at different volume levels. So, listening to them, one after another, will involve a lot of jumping for the volume knob. The Normalisation feature does not take care of this effectively; it simply makes the highest level in the track equal the maximum volume possible. But some songs still sound louder than others. A simple program called MP3 Gain provides the solution to this. It sets the audio level, based on how loud the human ear would perceive the sound signals to be. The results are quite impressive.

Click Add Folder on MP3 Gain's main button bar. Browse to the folder of your choice, and click OK. Now, click 'track analysis'—MP3 Gain will analyse each track, and may take quite a while to complete if you set many tracks to analyse. Next, set the target normal value in the text box—the default value of 89 makes the songs seem too soft. Enter 92, and then click 'Track Gain' to process all the tracks to that volume.

Now, rename and organize your media. This not only applies to the tunes you've just recorded, but also to the other few gigabytes of music hiding all over your hard drive.

We've tested three tools that aim to get your music collection into shape.

J. River Media Center 9

Media Center 9 aims to be your one-stop media shop, and does make a good effort too. The program is vast in its capabilities and options. It not only handles a large number of music formats, but also does stills and video files. It takes several shapes—from the normal full-size window, →

